

RFK ally seeks to pull polio vaccine

Lawyer helping to vet picks for health posts in incoming administration

By Christina Jewett
and Sheryl Gay Stolberg

NEW YORK TIMES

The lawyer helping Robert F. Kennedy Jr. pick federal health officials for the incoming Trump administration has petitioned the government to revoke its approval of the polio vaccine, which for decades has protected millions of people from a virus that can cause paralysis or death.

That campaign is just one front in the war that the lawyer, Aaron Siri, is waging against vaccines of all kinds.

Siri has also filed a petition seeking to pause the distribution of 13 other vaccines; challenged, and in some cases quashed, COVID-19 vaccine mandates around the country; sued federal agencies for the disclosure of records related to vaccine approvals; and subjected prominent vaccine scientists to grueling videotaped depositions.

Much of Siri's work — including the polio petition filed in 2022 — has been on behalf of the Informed Consent Action Network, a non-profit whose founder is a close ally of Kennedy. Siri also represented Kennedy during his presi-

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Union leaders upbeat on Labor choice

Optimism tempered by first Trump presidency

By Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — During his first term as president, Donald Trump's three choices for secretary of labor were a fast-food CEO and two conservative lawyers, all of whom were viewed by organized labor as big business allies deeply hostile to their interests.

So when Trump nominated as his second-term labor secretary a congresswoman who backed the most sweeping pro-labor bill since the FDR era and touted union endorsements in her ultimately unsuccessful reelection bid, it sparked an unfamiliar feeling among union leaders and their allies on Capitol Hill toward the president-elect.

Hope.

The level of optimism for Trump's pick, Representative Lori Chavez-DeRemer of Oregon, might vary or carry caveats, depending on the person. But there's a broad sense of relief among allies of organized labor that it might finally have an ally in a Republican administration after decades of antagonism.

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JOY IN DAMASCUS



OMAR HAJ KADOUR/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

A huge crowd of Syrians waved independence-era flags, used by the opposition since the uprising began in 2011, as they celebrated this week's fall of Bashar Assad's iron-fisted rule in Damascus's central Umayyad Square on Friday. Thousands also gathered outside a landmark mosque in Damascus to celebrate during the first Friday prayers since Assad's ouster. **A4.**

McKinsey to pay \$650m for opioid work

Consultant helped Purdue Pharma 'turbocharge' the sales of OxyContin

By Nick Stoico
and Travis Andersen

GLOBE STAFF

The consulting giant McKinsey & Company will pay \$650 million to settle criminal and civil probes of how it helped "turbocharge" sales of OxyContin for Purdue Pharma, the now-defunct company widely blamed for helping fuel the opioid crisis, federal authorities said Friday.

A former McKinsey senior partner, Martin Elling, also agreed to plead guilty to obstruction of justice for deleting documents related to the company's work with Purdue, authorities said. Elling, 60, a US citizen who currently lives in Bangkok, Thailand, faces up to 20 years in prison, three years probation, and a fine of up to \$250,000. He will be sentenced at a later date in federal court in Virginia, where the charge

was filed, prosecutors said.

The global consulting firm's deal with the Department of Justice requires the company to cease any work relating to controlled substances for five years and implement new policies to assess high-risk clients.

Federal authorities said the settlement marks the first time a management consulting firm has been held criminally responsible for advising a client to break the law. The agreement follows an investigation into McKinsey's dealings with Purdue that was led by the US attorneys

from Massachusetts and the Western District of Virginia.

"First and foremost, at bottom, this is a case about real people," Joshua S. Levy, the US attorney for Massachusetts, said during a briefing in Boston.. "This is a case about the thousands and thousands of people who've lost their lives to opioid addiction over the last many years."

Levy said the settlement represents "one further step" in the federal government's push to combat the opioid crisis that has ravaged com-

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'They have thrown the largest curve ball into this deal that jeopardizes everything.'

LORRAINE
TOMLINSON-HALL
*Barbara Lynch's chief
operating officer*

Tax lawsuit puts sales of Lynch restaurants on hold

Deals — and jobs — upended as Boston seeks \$1.7m payment

By Janelle Nanos

GLOBE STAFF

An executive overseeing the management of Barbara Lynch's restaurant group says the city's lawsuit for \$1.7 million in unpaid personal property taxes has thrown planned sales of Lynch's two remaining restaurants — No. 9 Park and B&G Oysters — into limbo, imperiling dozens of jobs.

A group of local investors have an

agreement in place to buy No. 9 Park and keep open the Beacon Hill fine-dining institution, said Lynch's chief operating officer Lorraine Tomlinson-Hall, while there are two offers to purchase South End oyster joint B&G. Now, Tomlinson-Hall says both sales, and the jobs of 62 restaurant staff, are on hold.

"They have brought us to a grinding halt," she said. "They have thrown the largest curve ball into this deal that jeopardizes everything."

The suit last month raises questions about why the city allowed these taxes to accumulate for 11 years before suddenly filing a lawsuit. It also highlights

LYNCH, Page B4

Texas has sued a New York doctor for prescribing abortion pills to a woman near Dallas, launching one of the first challenges to shield laws passed to protect physicians after Roe v. Wade was overturned. **A2.**

A lawyer for Lindsay Clancy filed formal notice that the Duxbury woman charged with killing her three children before trying unsuccessfully to end her own life will pursue an insanity defense. **B1.**

Boston NPR news station WBUR is canceling "Radio Boston" as part of an overhaul of its schedule and coverage. **D1.**



I am in glove

Saturday: Sunny, cold.
High: 32-37. Low: 20-25.

Sunday: Becoming cloudy.
High: 33-38. Low: 28-33.

Sunrise: 7:06 Sunset: 4:12
Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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North toward hope

For years, Germany welcomed immigrants. But now tougher policies, far-right backlash are in play.

STORY BY ELIZABETH KOH | GLOBE STAFF

Refugees from Ukraine stood by a bus at the initial reception center for refugees in Hesse, Germany, in September.



BORIS ROESSLER/PICTURE ALLIANCE VIA GETTY IMAGES

BERLIN — The young Ukrainian couple knew, even as they fled to Germany, that their new home might not want them.

Alona and her husband, Vladyslav, had traveled two days by bus to get to Berlin's largest refugee camp — a sea of white tents and trailers at the city's former airport, filled with roughly 5,000 others seeking asylum. Since they'd arrived, they'd seen the headlines in the German news about harsher policies toward migrants and populist politicians declaring there weren't enough resources to go around.

But what choice did they have?

"We were afraid for our safety," said Alona, 27, who asked that only their first names be used out of fear of retaliation. "We would be happy to live in Ukraine if it had been safe there."

The young couple is among millions of migrants who have come to Germany in the last several decades, driven by conflict, or in search of a more prosperous life. At first welcoming to the newcomers, Germany has increasingly reversed course over the last decade and turned to tougher deterrence measures, such as cutting

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